

# Abdullah Al Zahid

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## **Talent Acquisition**

Airport Planning and Design

Stantec Consulting Ltd., Toronto, ON

## **Re: Senior Aviation Planner - Airports**

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Aviation Planner position with the Airport Planning and Design team. I come to it from transportation planning rather than aviation, so I want to be clear about both what I would bring and where I fall short.

The posting covers ground transportation facilities and commercial land development at airports as well as airside and terminal work, and the landside is where my experience applies. At the City of Toronto I analyze travel and network data to establish where capacity falls short, review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them, and write the reports and presentations that carry findings to managers and outside agencies. The operational side of facility planning, testing whether a design will cope with the demand placed on it, is what I have done with simulation: traffic simulation of Ontario Line construction staging at Mott MacDonald, OpenTrack simulation of GO rail services at Metrolinx, and agent-based MATSim models in my master's research.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. Building tools like these is how I approach analysis generally: set up the method once, then spend the time on what the results mean.

The gaps are real. I have no airport planning experience: I have not prepared airport master plans or airfield and terminal concept plans, and I have not used AutoCAD Civil 3D or Aviplan. I have not managed consulting projects or supported pursuits. A senior role expects aviation experience I do not yet have, so I would also welcome being considered for the Aviation Planner position the team has posted, where I could build that experience.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

*Abdullah Al Zahid*

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